

Doug Vargas

Head of Product · Design Engineer

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I'm a product designer who builds. Today I'm Head of Product at Naowee, where I set direction across the eight business modules of the platform built for Colombia's sports system, and build the prototypes that define them. Before that I was technical lead on Andes, the design system behind Mercadolibre across 18 countries, used by 400+ designers and 2,000+ engineers. Earlier I spent five years and two months at Aval Digital Labs as the gatekeeper of Banco de Occidente's design system, and built the bank's digital banking flows for desktop, tablet and mobile. I work in code as well as in Figma, with AI in the loop, and the thing I hand over is a running product.

EXPERIENCE

Jan 2026 – Now

Naowee

Head of Product Barranquilla, Colombia · Remote

Product direction for SUID, the platform built for Colombia's sports system. I set direction across eight business modules and build the prototypes that define them.

- **Product direction across 8 business modules** — inspection and control over ~1,200 sports organizations and their 30 regulatory procedures, plus events, venues, incentives, convocatorias and scoring.
- **One design system, and I build in it** — 38+ components, a canonical shell and a single wizard recipe holding 130+ screens to one language.
- **Modeled the sector's real hierarchy** — committees, federations, leagues, clubs and athletes with cascading approval, across 45+ states and 15 roles.
- **Working prototypes instead of specs** — built in code, then walked story by story with analysts who sign off against the running product.

Jan 2024 – Jan 2026

Mercadolibre · Andes Design System

Tech Lead · Design Systems LATAM · Remote

Technical lead on Andes, the design system behind Mercadolibre's commerce, fintech and shipping products across 18 countries.

- **Design library maintained across iOS, Android and Web** — used by 400+ designers and 2,000+ engineers.
- **Foundational definitions** — tokens, spacing, type and motion governing the product suite across 18 countries.
- **Cross-platform work with engineering** — component APIs agreed once and shipped the same on every platform.

- **AI inside the systems practice** — prompt-driven audits that catch system drift in Figma before it ships.

Nov 2018 – Jan 2024

Aval Digital Labs · Banco de Occidente

Senior Product Designer · Design System Gatekeeper `Bogotá, Colombia · Hybrid`

Senior product designer for Banco de Occidente's digital banking, and the official gatekeeper of the design system shared across the bank's product squads.

- **Design System Gatekeeper** — governed additions, deprecations and patterns across 12+ product squads.
- **Built Velocity, the bank's design system** — documentation, foundations, atoms, molecules and organisms, on atomic-design principles.
- **Redesigned core banking flows** — login and registration, accounts and cards, transfers and payments, for desktop, tablet and mobile.
- **System literacy** — workshops, classes and crits, plus mentorship for junior and mid-level designers.

Aug 2017 – Nov 2018

Globant · Royal Caribbean

Senior Product Designer `Medellín, Colombia · On-site`

Mobile and web design for Royal Caribbean cruises, from Globant's Medellín studio, with product and engineering based in the US.

- **Booking and onboard guest experience** — mobile flows across destinations, stateroom types and life aboard.
- **Designed for intermittent connectivity** — schedules, dining, excursions and balances that hold up at sea.
- **Cross-functional collaboration** with US-based product and engineering teams.

Oct 2016 – Aug 2017

Qrvey · Survey & NPS Platform

Lead UI Designer `Barranquilla, Colombia · On-site`

- **Owned the visual language** of the product, mobile and web.
- **Designed AutomatiQ end to end** — the process list, the trigger cards, the condition editor and the actions they fire.

Mar 2016 – Aug 2017

Ideaware

Senior UX/UI Designer `Barranquilla, Colombia · On-site`

- **Wireframes, UI kits and prototypes** delivered developer-ready across web and mobile.
- **A new domain on every engagement** — the multi-domain fluency that later made systems work feel natural.

EARLIER

Oct 2014 – Feb 2016 **Smartbiz Solutions** Junior UI Designer

First UI role. Interface design for web and mobile client projects, and the first time I worked inside a shared component library instead of one-off screens.

Feb 2010 – Oct 2014 **Freelance** Graphic & Interface Designer

Independent graphic and interface design for local clients — brand systems, print and early web work.

EDUCATION

2006 – 2009
Professional Graphic Designer
Universidad Autónoma del Caribe

CERTIFICATIONS

2018
Design Foundations
Globant

2020
Design System Essentials
Aval Digital Labs

2022
Introduction to UI
Coursera

LANGUAGES

Spanish · Native

English · B1 · Working proficiency

SKILLS

PRODUCT

Product direction, Design thinking, User research & surveys, User journeys, User flows, A/B testing, Wireframing, Prototyping

DESIGN SYSTEMS

Tokens & foundations, Component libraries, Governance, Documentation, UI kits, Atomic design, Cross-platform parity

ENGINEERING

TypeScript & JavaScript, React & Next.js, Node.js, Automated testing, PWA & service workers, IndexedDB, Content Security Policy, Git

AI IN THE BUILD

Prototyping in code with AI, Generative UI, LLM-driven flows, Prompt-driven design audits, Structured tool calls, On-device and privacy constraints

PLATFORMS

iOS, Android, Web, Responsive, Web & app interactions, No-code tools

TOOLS

Figma Claude Gemini

DESIGN

Figma, Sketch, Adobe XD, Illustrator, Photoshop, Balsamiq, InVision, Marvel, Spline, Webflow

CODE

Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub, Storybook

AI

Claude, Gemini, ChatGPT, Midjourney

COLLABORATION

Jira, Notion